RABBI BINYAMIN GOLDBERG

Hilchos Shabbos Shiur 19

Shiur

19

הלכות שבת · אורח חיים סימן ר"ס

Mareh Makomos for this shiur

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Gemora Shabbos 25b, 34a; Nidda 17a; Gittin 6b

Rambam, Hilchos Shabbos 5:3, 30:2

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5787 · 2026

Washing and Preparing Oneself for Shabbos

Simon 260

Seif 1 סעיף א

BASIS OF THIS SEIF Kavod Shabbos | Erev Shabbos

- Washing is a mitzva because of the honor of Shabbos, but not a full obligation: one who fulfills it is rewarded, one who does not is not punished (MB 1).
- Cutting the hair is so that he not enter Shabbos unkempt (MB 7). Thursday is avoided because nails begin to grow back on the third day, so it is no improvement for the honor of Shabbos (MB 6); the Taz applies the same to haircutting (Taz 1).
- The Mishna Berura warns that the washing must not lead to Shabbos desecration – combing the hair is a Torah-level melacha, and wringing the towel is in the category of laundering (MB 1).

Melacha: Named by MB 1 as risks of the washing itself: combing the hair, which it calls a Torah-level melacha, and wringing the towel, which is in the category of laundering – *Melabein* (מלבן #13).

Background *(general; not stated in the seif): Combing pulls out hair; compare* גוזז *#12. The mitzva of washing itself involves no melacha.*

Washing for Shabbos

HALACHA 260:1

The Gemara (Shabbos 25b) relates of Rabbi Yehuda bar Ilai that on Erev Shabbos "they would bring him a basin full of hot water and he would wash his face, his hands and his feet." From this the poskim derive the mitzva here. It is a mitzva **1)** because of the honor of Shabbos, but not a full obligation: one who fulfills it receives reward, and one who does not is not punished (MB 1). The **Biur Halacha** (ד״ה מצוה) notes that the Gemara implies that even one whose Torah study is his occupation should interrupt it for this – though there only the face, hands and feet are mentioned.

The Rama adds the whole body **3)**, in hot water. The **Biur Halacha** (ד״ה כל גופו) brings the Eliya Rabba's doubt about the Tur's ruling, and concludes that if he obtained only a little hot water at the bathhouse it is better to wash his face, hands and feet with it, since that is explicit in the Gemara. The washing must be in hot water; the **Biur Halacha** (ד״ה בחמין) leaves lukewarm water in doubt, rules that cold water certainly does not fulfill the mitzva, but suggests that if after rinsing in cold water he warmed himself thoroughly in a steam room, that is in the category of washing in hot water (compare 326:4).

The mitzva applies to women as well; in the short winter days, when there is no time, women – and men too – may fulfill it with the face and hands (MB 2). Washing the feet **4)** is no longer the practice, possibly because in their lands people went barefoot and washed off the dust, which is not so in ours (MB 4). Washing the head is part of the mitzva; the **Biur Halacha** (ד״ה לחוף הראש) notes that the poskim do not actually mention hot water for this, and anything that cleans the head suffices – in the time of the Gemara they used natron and the like.

All this applies to Erev Yom Tov too **5)**. Thursday is not the honor of Shabbos, unless Erev Shabbos is impossible, and then the closer to Shabbos the better (MB 5).

The **Mishna Berura** (1) adds a sharp warning. One must be very careful that the mitzva of washing not lead to desecrating Shabbos. In the short winter days many sit almost until dark; and even if the washing itself was finished permissibly, a prohibition can still present itself – combing the hair, which is a Torah-level melacha on Shabbos, or wringing out the towel, which is in the category of laundering (302). "It is fitting for everyone in whose heart the fear of Hashem has touched to prevent the people from this," both for the merit of the public and so as not to be caught in their sin: "whoever is able to protest against the people of his city and does not protest is caught for the sin of the people of his city."

Haircutting and Nails

Cutting the hair **7)**, with a razor or scissors, is so that he not enter Shabbos unkempt (MB 7). The **Magen Avraham** (1) brings the Bach in the name of the Maharshal that one should cut on Erev Shabbos and not Thursday, since on Thursday it is not evident that it is for Shabbos. He objects from the Mishna in Taanis, which permits the *anshei maamad* to cut hair on Thursday "because of the honor of Shabbos" – and Rashi there says that most people cut on Thursday because of the burden of Shabbos. He answers that Erev Shabbos is nevertheless the choicest way, and the *anshei maamad* simply were not free then. The **Taz** (1) quotes the Maharshal at length, including the Rokeach's two derivations of sharpening the knife – from "and it shall be on the sixth day, and they shall prepare," and from "and you shall know that your tent is at peace," "for if the iron is dull and does not cut, there is no peace in the home."

The reason given for avoiding Thursday is that nails begin to grow back on the third day, so it is no improvement for the honor of Shabbos (MB 6); the Taz applies the same to haircutting (Taz 1). Some do not cut hair (MA 1) – and do not take nails either (MB 7) – on Rosh Chodesh, even when it falls on Friday, as Rabbi Yehuda HaChasid commanded.

The Magen Avraham brings from the Magid Meisharim that the hands and feet should not be done on the same day – the feet on Thursday and the hands on Friday (MA 1; MB 6). The Gemara (Nidda 17a) says: "One who burns his nail clippings is pious; one who buries them is righteous; one who throws them away is wicked" – lest a pregnant woman step over them and miscarry. Therefore in a study hall or a men's bathhouse one may throw them. The Gemara adds that they can harm only where they fell; so if he gathered and removed them, there is nothing in it. The Perisha derives that one who cut them at home where women are found should sweep the place and move them; the Eliya Rabba suggests that only throwing them outside the room counts as a change of place (MB 6). One should wash the hands after cutting the nails (MB 6; siman 4). The Pri Megadim (EA 1) brings the Tolaas Yaakov's reason.

The order of cutting **8)** is from the Avudraham. The **Taz** (2) and the Magen Avraham note that the Tashbetz writes that the Maharam was not particular about this, and so it is written of the Arizal – the Magen Avraham reports that he "would deride this." Still, one should be careful initially (MB 8). The Pri Megadim (MZ 2) notes that the Tosefes Shabbos, in the name of the Kavanos, says the opposite – that the Arizal *was* particular – and offers a homiletic hint in the mnemonic: nails represent superfluities, and pursuing superfluities in this world is "a great worry" for the World to Come. Rabbi Akiva Eiger cites the Ateres Zekeinim with a different order for the right hand.

SHULCHAN ARUCH & MEFORSHIM

דיני הכנסת שבת. ובו ב סעיפים

מצוה לרחוץ:

הגה כל גופו. ואם א"א לו, ירחץ (טור)

פניו ידיו ורגליו בחמין בע"ש; ומצוה לחוף הראש ולגלח הצפרנים בע"ש:

הגה ואם היו שערות ראשו גדולות, מצוה לגלחן (א"ז פ' אלו מגלחין). וכשנוטל צפרניו לא יטול אותן כסדרן. ויתחיל בשמאל, בקמיצה; ובימין, באצבע. וסי' לזה: דבהג"א, בשמאל; ובדאג"ה, בימין (אבודרהם בספר המוסר):

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1 It is a mitzva 1) to wash 2)

RAMA *his whole body* **3)***; and if that is impossible for him, he should wash* (Tur)

his face, his hands and his feet 4) in hot water on Erev Shabbos 5). And it is a mitzva to wash the head and to cut the nails on Erev Shabbos 6).

RAMA *And if the hair of his head has grown long, it is a mitzva to cut it* **7)** (Or Zarua, perek Elu Megalchin). *And when he takes his nails, he should not take them in order* **8)***: he should begin on the left with the ring finger, and on the right with the index finger. And the sign for this is* דבהג"א *on the left and* בדאג"ה *on the right* (Avudraham, in the Sefer HaMusar).

COMMENTARIES, IN ORDER OF THE TEXT

It is a mitzva to wash **מצוה לרחוץ**

TAZ 1 **ט"ז (א)**

מצוה לרחוץ כו'. ל' רש"ל ויטול צפרניו כל ע' ש וישחוז סכינו כמ"ש רז"ל והיה ביום הששי והכינו זה השחזת הסכין ועוד דרשו וידעת כי שלם אהלך זה השחזת הסכין כי אם כיהה הברזל ולא יחתוך אין זה שלום בית (רוקח) עוד בהג"ה מצוה להסתפר לכבוד שבת ויו"ט ואפי' מצפרא דע"ש מנכרא דליקרא דשבתא קעביד אבל ביום ה' לא מנכרא יקרא דשבתא ואף דגרסי' במרובה מן י' תקנות שמכבסין בגדים בה' בשבת לכבוד שבת שאני התם דטרידי לכבוס בערב שבת ועוד דאין לובשין אותם בערב שבת מיהו היכא דלא אפשר לרחוץ ולספר בערב שבת כל דאפשר למקרב לשבת טפי מעליא עכ"ה ובנטילת צפרנים יש טעם בדבר על מה שאין נוטלין ביום ה' עד כאן לשון מהרש"ל

> **It is a mitzva to wash etc.** The language of the Maharshal: "And he should cut his nails every Erev Shabbos and sharpen his knife, as our Sages of blessed memory said on 'and it shall be on the sixth day, and they shall prepare' – this is sharpening the knife; and they further expounded 'and you shall know that your tent is at peace' – this is sharpening the knife, for if the iron is dull and does not cut, there is no peace in the home (Rokeach). Further, in a gloss: it is a mitzva to cut one's hair for the honor of Shabbos and Yom Tov. And even from the morning of Erev Shabbos it is evident that he does it for the honor of Shabbos; but on Thursday the honor of Shabbos is not evident. And although we learn in [perek] Merubeh, among the ten enactments, that they launder clothes on Thursday for the honor of Shabbos – there it is different, since on Erev Shabbos they are too busy to launder, and further, they do not wear them on Erev Shabbos. However, where it is impossible to wash and cut one's hair on Erev Shabbos, the closer one can bring it to Shabbos the better" – end of his words. "And with cutting the nails there is a reason for the matter, why they are not taken on Thursday" – end of the Maharshal's language.

ומה שמסיים שיש טעם בנטילת צפרנים שמעתי הטעם דדרך השערות והצפרנים המגולחים להתחיל לצמוח ביום ג' שאחר הנטילה ע"כ אין לעשות שיהיה זה בשבת וע"כ גם בגילוח שערות אין לעשות ביום ה':

> And as to what he concludes, that there is a reason with cutting the nails – I have heard the reason: that the way of cut hair and nails is to begin to grow on the third day after the cutting; therefore one should not do it so that this falls on Shabbos. And therefore with cutting the hair too one should not do it on Thursday.

PRI MEGADIM (MISHBETZOS ZAHAV) 1 on Taz 1 **פרי מגדים – משבצות זהב (א)**

מצוה עט"ז הביאו הב"ח ג"כ. ומ"ש דאין לובשין אותו בע"ש היינו אם יכבס בע"ש לא ילבש אותו בע"ש דקשה הוא ללובשו מיד. וכל כמה דמקרב לשבת טפי עדיף ביום ה' שייך לשבת הבאה ואם א"א כל מה דמקריב עדיף ועא"ר ח' הביא מנזיר דף ה' אבשלום היה מגלח מע"ש לע"ש בפניא ושאר אחוהי בצפרא יע"ש דמשמע מצוה מצפרא. ועס" רנ"א במ"א ה' ולמ"ד מ"ג אבשלום משום היכרא דהוא נזיר היה מגלח בפניא ולמ"ד מ"ק י"ל אחר חצות מצוה טפי ושאר אחוהי מנהגם כך.

> **It is a mitzva – on the Taz.** The Bach brought it as well. And what he wrote, that they do not wear them on Erev Shabbos, means that if he launders on Erev Shabbos he will not wear it on Erev Shabbos, for it is hard to wear it immediately. And "the closer to Shabbos the better" – on Thursday it belongs to the coming Shabbos; and if it is impossible, the closer the better. And see the Eliya Rabba 8, who brought from Nazir daf 5 that Avshalom would cut his hair from Erev Shabbos to Erev Shabbos in the afternoon, and his other brothers in the morning; see there – it is implied that the mitzva is from the morning. And see siman 251 in the Magen Avraham 5. And according to the one who says מ"ג, Avshalom – because of a recognizable sign that he was a nazir – would cut in the afternoon; and according to the one who says מ"ק, one can say that after midday is more of a mitzva, and his other brothers' custom was so.

ומ"ש הט"ז ביום ה' שיהיה זה בשבת עא"ר ה' כתב דהטעם כיון דצומח בשבת א"כ אין זה תיקון כבוד שבת שחוזר לצאת וכ"ש בד' כה"ג כו' יע"ש ועתו"ש אות ג' בשם כה"ג דשערות מגדלין תיכף אחר הגילוח:

> And what the Taz wrote, "on Thursday, that this should fall on Shabbos" – the Eliya Rabba 5 wrote that the reason is that since it grows on Shabbos, this is not an improvement for the honor of Shabbos, since it goes back to growing out, and all the more so on Wednesday in such a case etc.; see there. And see the Tosefes Shabbos paragraph 3 in the name of the Kenesses HaGedolah, that hair grows immediately after the cutting.

לא יטול אותן כסדרן. *He should not take them in order*

MAGEN AVRAHAM 1 **מגן אברהם (א)**

כתב הב"ח בשם רש"ל יש לספר בע"ש ולא ביום ה' שאין ניכר שעושה לכבוד שבת ובנטילת צפרנים יש טעם יפה שאין נוטלין בה' עכ"ל

> The Bach wrote in the name of the Maharshal: one should cut his hair on Erev Shabbos and not on Thursday, for [then] it is not evident that he does it for the honor of Shabbos; and with cutting the nails there is a good reason why one does not cut them on Thursday – end quote.

וצ"ע דמשנה שלימה שנינו בפ"ב ופ"ד דתענית ובחמישי מותרין מפני כבוד השבת ופירש"י דרך רוב בני אדם לספר בה' ולא בע"ש מפני טורח שבת עכ"ל ואפשר דמ"מ מצוה מן המובחר בע"ש אלא שאנשי מעמד לא היו פנוים בע"ש

> And this needs study, for we learned a complete Mishna in perek 2 and perek 4 of Taanis: "and on Thursday they are permitted, because of the honor of Shabbos"; and Rashi explained: "it is the way of most people to cut their hair on Thursday and not on Erev Shabbos, because of the burden of Shabbos" – end quote. And possibly nevertheless the choicest way of the mitzva is on Erev Shabbos, except that the *anshei maamad* were not free on Erev Shabbos.

ויש מקומות שאין מגלחים בר"ח אפי' חל ביום ו' כי כן צוה ר"י חסיד (כ"ה) ובמגי"מ במשלי כ' שאין לקוץ צפרני הידים והרגלים ביום א' ואין לקוץ אלא בע"ש או בעי"ט והנכון שיקוץ מן הרגלים ביום ה' ומן הידים ביום ו' ובשאר הימים אין לקוץ כלל ומט"מ כ' בשם ספר הגן שלא ליטלן ביום ה' מפני שגדלין בשבת, השורף צפרניו חסיד קוברן צדיק זורקן רשע (נדה דף י"ז):

> **And there are places where they do not cut hair on Rosh Chodesh, even when it falls on Friday, for so Rabbi Yehuda HaChasid commanded (Kenesses HaGedolah). And in the Magid Meisharim, on Mishlei, it is written that one should not cut the nails of the hands and the feet on one day, and one should cut them only on Erev Shabbos or Erev Yom Tov; and the correct way is to cut the feet on Thursday and the hands on Friday, and on the other days one should not cut at all. And the Mateh Moshe wrote in the name of the Sefer HaGan not to take them on Thursday, because they grow on Shabbos. "One who burns his nail clippings is pious; one who buries them is righteous; one who throws them away is wicked" (Niddah 17a).**

לא יטול אותן כסדרן . והאר"י היה מלעיג ע"ז ולא היה חושש לכך (הכונות) וכ"כ התשב"ץ סי' קנ"ד בשם מהר"מ מיהו יש ליזהר לכתחלה:

He should not take them in order. And the Arizal would deride this and was not concerned about it (Kavanos). And so wrote the Tashbetz siman 154 in the name of the Maharam. However, one should be careful initially.

PRI MEGADIM (ESHEL AVRAHAM) 1 on Magen Avraham 1 **פרי מגדים – אשל אברהם (א)**

כתב הב"ח בשם רש"ל כו' עמ"א עמ"ש בט"ז א' מזה עא"ר ד' בשם של"ה מי שטובל בע"ש יטול קודם טבילה וקודם שיקרא שמו"ת. ועמ"ש באות ז"י"ן פ' אלו מגלחין דנשים שעוברים על צפרנים סכנה שמא תפיל כי אדם הראשון קודם חטא היה לבושו ציפורן לאחר חטא נפשט ולא נשאר רק באצבעות ואשה גרמה זאת לכן יש סכנה תולעת יעקב. ואם מכנסן לחדר אחר לית לן בה אבל באותו חדר למקום אחר מפקפק שם בא"ר אי מהני יע"ש:

"The Bach wrote in the name of the Maharshal etc." – on the Magen Avraham. See what I wrote about this in Taz 1. And the Eliya Rabba 4, in the name of the Shelah: one who immerses on Erev Shabbos should take [his nails] before immersing and before he reads *shnayim mikra v'echad targum*. And see what I wrote in paragraph 7: in perek Elu Megalchin, [regarding] women who step over nail clippings there is danger, lest she miscarry – for Adam before the sin, his garment was [like] a nail, and after the sin it was stripped away and remained only on the fingers, and a woman caused this; therefore there is danger (Tolaas Yaakov). And if he brings them into another room there is nothing in it; but [moving them] within the same room to another place – the Eliya Rabba there questions whether it helps; see there.

לא עמ"א בא"ר אות ו"י"ו בשם כל בו ס"ס פ"ז דיטול תחלה יד שמאל ואח"כ יד ימין:

He should not – on the Magen Avraham. In the Eliya Rabba paragraph 6, in the name of the Kol Bo at the end of siman 87, that he should take the left hand first and afterwards the right hand.

TAZ 2 **ט"ז (ב)**

לא יטול אותם כסדרן. בתשב"ץ כתוב שמהר"מ לא דקדק בזה וכ"כ בספר כוונת האר"י על שם מהר"י לורי"א:

He should not take them in order. In the Tashbetz it is written that the Maharam was not particular about this; and so it is written in the Sefer Kavanos HaArizal in the name of Rabbi Yitzchak Luria.

PRI MEGADIM (MISHBETZOS ZAHAV) 2 on Taz 2 **פרי מגדים – משבצות זהב (ב)**

לא עט"ז וכ"כ מ"א א' ובתו"ש אות ד' בשם כוונות י"ל להיפך שהאר"י ז"ל היה מקפיד בזה. ועיין פרישה וא"ר סימן ה' קשיא בלא תירוץ פירוש קמיצה שמאל ימין אצבע בלא תירו"ץ שלא כסדר (תירוץ הוא סידור וישובם כו')

He should not – on the Taz. And so wrote the Magen Avraham 1. And in the Tosefes Shabbos paragraph 4, in the name of the Kavanos, one can say the opposite – that the Arizal, of blessed memory, was particular about this. And see the Perisha and the Eliya Rabba siman 5: *kashya b'lo tiruts* ("a difficulty without an answer") – the meaning being: *kemitza* [the ring finger] on the left, and on the right the *etzba* [the index finger]; "*b'lo tiruts*" [means] not in order (*tiruts* means arranging and settling them etc.).

ורמז יש בדבר בימין בדאג"ה כי הצפרנים מורים על המותרות וכל מה שאדם רודף אחר המותרות בעוה"ז בטל הוא מתורה ומ"ט לעוה"ב וגם א"א שלא ינוכה לו לעוה"ב ודאי דאגה גדולה הוא זה ע"ד אורך ימים בימינה ובשמאלה עושר וכבוד ועוה"ז נקרא שמאל כד"א אף ידי יסדה ארץ וימיני טפחה שמים אם רודף אחר המותרות גם בעוה"ז יש לו דאגה אך לא כ"כ כמו לעוה"ב:

And there is a hint in the matter, in the right hand *b'daaga* ("with worry"): for the nails indicate superfluities; and however much a person pursues superfluities in this world he is idle from Torah and mitzvos for the World to Come, and also it is impossible that it not be deducted from him for the World to Come – this is certainly a great worry. This is in line with "length of days is in her right hand, and in her left hand riches and honor"; and this world is called "left", as it is said, "My hand also has founded the earth, and My right hand has spanned the heavens." If he pursues superfluities, in this world too he has worry, but not as much as for the World to Come.

RABBI AKIVA EIGER **רבי עקיבא איגר**

סעיף א' בהג"ה כסדרן עיין עטרת זקנים לעיל סי' רמ"א בשם אבודרה"ם דבימין אגבה"ד וכן כ' באבן שהם:

Seif 1, in the gloss: "in order". See the Ateres Zekeinim above, siman 241, in the name of the Avudraham, that in the right hand [the order is] אגבה"ד; and so it is written in the Even Shoham.

MISHNA BERURA ON THIS SEIF

MISHNA BERURA 1 **משנה ברורה (א)**

מצוה וכו' – מפני כבוד השבת ומ"מ אין זה חובה גמורה והמקיימה מקבל עליה שכר ושאינו מקיימה אינו נענש עליה.

> **It is a mitzva etc.** – Because of the honor of Shabbos. Nevertheless this is not a complete obligation: one who fulfills it receives reward for it, and one who does not fulfill it is not punished for it.

ומאד יש ליזהר שלא יבוא ע"י מצות הרחיצה לחשש חילול שבת ובעו"ה הרבה נכשלין בזה בימי החורף כשהימים קצרים שיושבין כמעט עד שחשיכה ואף אם גמר את עצם הרחיצה בהיתר ג"כ מזדמן איסור לידו שפעמים הוא סורק את ראשו בסוף שהיא מלאכה דאורייתא בשבת. גם מצוי שאחר גמר כל הפעולות סוחט האלונטית מהמים שנבלע בו והוא בכלל מכבס וכמו שיבואר לקמן בסימן ש"ב.

> And one must be very careful that through the mitzva of washing he not come to a concern of desecrating Shabbos. Due to our many sins, many stumble in this in the winter days, when the days are short and they sit almost until dark. And even if he finished the actual washing permissibly, a prohibition still presents itself to him: sometimes he combs his head at the end, which is a Torah-level melacha on Shabbos. It also commonly happens that after finishing everything he wrings the towel of the water absorbed in it, which is in the category of laundering, as will be explained below in siman 302.

וראוי לכל מי שנגע יראת השם בלבו למנוע את העם מזה וזכות הרבים יהיה תלוי בו וגם כדי שלא יתפש ח"ו בעונם וכידוע מאמר חז"ל כל מי שיש לו למחות באנשי ביתו ואינו מוחה נתפס בעון אנשי ביתו וכל מי שיש לו למחות באנשי עירו ואינו מוחה נתפס בעון אנשי עירו:

> And it is fitting for everyone in whose heart the fear of Hashem has touched to prevent the people from this, and the merit of the public will depend on him; and also so that he not be caught, heaven forbid, in their sin – as our Sages' well-known statement: "Whoever is able to protest against his household and does not protest is caught for the sin of his household; and whoever is able to protest against the people of his city and does not protest is caught for the sin of the people of his city."

MISHNA BERURA 2 **משנה ברורה (ב)**

לרחוץ – וגם על הנשים שייך מצות רחיצה ובימי החורף שהימים קצרים ואין להם פנאי יקיימו מצות הרחיצה בפניהם וידיהם ואף לאנשים די בזה כשאין להם פנאי ועיין בא"ר:

> **To wash** – The mitzva of washing applies to women as well. And in the winter days, when the days are short and they have no time, they should fulfill the mitzva of washing with their faces and their hands; and for men too this suffices when they have no time. And see the Eliya Rabba.

MISHNA BERURA 3 **משנה ברורה (ג)**

כל גופו – היינו בחמין:

> **His whole body** – That is, in hot water.

MISHNA BERURA 4 **משנה ברורה (ד)**

ורגליו – וכעת אין נוהגין ליזהר בזה ואפשר דדוקא במדינותיהם שהיו רגילין לילך יחף ודרכו לרחוץ במים מפני האבק והעפר משא"כ במדינותינו וכעין זה כתב הפמ"ג לעיל בסימן ד' באשל אברהם סק"א עי"ש:

> **And his feet** – And nowadays people are not accustomed to be careful about this. And possibly it was specifically in their lands, where they were accustomed to go barefoot and it was their way to wash in water because of the dust and dirt; not so in our lands. The Pri Megadim wrote something similar above in siman 4 in the Eshel Avraham, s"k 1; see there.

MISHNA BERURA 5 **משנה ברורה (ה)**

בע"ש – וה"ה בכל זה בעיו"ט אבל ביום ה' לא הוי יקריה דשבת אא"כ אי אפשר לו לרחוץ בע"ש אז כל כמה דמקרב לשבת טפי מעלי וכן לענין להסתפר:

> **On Erev Shabbos** – And the same applies in all this on Erev Yom Tov. But on Thursday it is not the honor of Shabbos – unless it is impossible for him to wash on Erev Shabbos, and then the closer to Shabbos the better. And likewise regarding cutting one's hair.

MISHNA BERURA 6 **משנה ברורה (ו)**

בע"ש – וביום ה' מקפידין שלא ליטלן מפני שהצפרנים מתחילין לחזור ולצמוח ביום ג' לגלוחן וא"כ אין זה תיקון כבוד שבת שחוזר לצאת.

> **On Erev Shabbos** – And on Thursday they are particular not to take them, because the nails begin to grow back on the third day after their cutting; if so, this is not an improvement for the honor of Shabbos, since it goes back to growing out.

יש שכתבו שלא לקוץ צפרני הידים ורגלים ביום אחד ואין לקוץ אלא בע"ש או בעיו"ט והנכון שיקוץ מן הרגלים ביום ה' ומן הידים ביום ו' [מ"א].

> Some have written not to cut the nails of the hands and the feet on one day, and that one should cut them only on Erev Shabbos or Erev Yom Tov; and the correct way is to cut the feet on Thursday and the hands on Friday [Magen Avraham].

איתא בגמרא השורף צפרנים חסיד קוברן צדיק זורקן רשע שמא תעבור עליהן אשה מעוברת ותפיל ולכן בבית המדרש דלא שכיחי נשי או בית המרחץ שעשוי רק להרחצת אנשים מותר לזרוק. גם איתא שם בגמרא דאין בכחן להזיק רק בדוכתא דנפילי אבל אי כניש להו בתר הכי ושדי להו לאבראי לית לן בה וכתב בפרישה סימן רמ"א מכאן דאם חתך בביתו במקום דשכיחי נשי ונפל מידו קצת צפרניו יכבד אותו המקום ויזיזם ממקומם ושוב לית לן בה והא"ר כתב דאפשר דדוקא כשהשליכן חוץ לחדר הוי שינוי מקום. ויש ליטול הידים אחר גילוח הצפרנים וכדלעיל בסימן ד':

> It is stated in the Gemara: "One who burns his nail clippings is pious; one who buries them is righteous; one who throws them away is wicked" – lest a pregnant woman pass over them and miscarry. Therefore, in a study hall, where women are not found, or in a bathhouse made only for washing men, it is permitted to throw them. It is also stated there in the Gemara that they have the power to harm only in the place where they fell; but if he gathered them afterwards and threw them outside, there is nothing in it. And the Perisha wrote in siman 241 that from here [we learn] that if he cut them in his house in a place where women are found and some of his nails fell from his hand, he should sweep that place and move them from their place, and then there is nothing in it. And the Eliya Rabba wrote that possibly it is specifically when he throws them outside the room that it is a change of place. And one should wash the hands after cutting the nails, as above in siman 4.

MISHNA BERURA 7 **משנה ברורה (ז)**

לגלחן – בתער או במספרים והטעם כדי שלא יכנוס לשבת כשהוא מנוול. יש מקומות שאין מגלחין ואין נוטלין צפורנים בר"ח אפילו חל ביום עש"ק כי כן צוה ר"י חסיד:

> **To cut them** – With a razor or with scissors. And the reason is so that he not enter Shabbos while he is unkempt. There are places where they do not cut hair and do not take nails on Rosh Chodesh, even when it falls on Erev Shabbos, for so Rabbi Yehuda HaChasid commanded.

MISHNA BERURA 8 **משנה ברורה (ח)**

לא יטול וכו' – בתשב"ץ כתוב שמהר"ם לא דקדק בזה וכ"כ על האר"י מ"מ יש ליזהר לכתחילה [מ"א]:

> **He should not take etc.** – In the Tashbetz it is written that the Maharam was not particular about this, and so it is written about the Arizal. Nevertheless one should be careful initially [Magen Avraham].

Seif 2 סעיף ב

BASIS OF THIS SEIF Kavod Shabbos | Erev Shabbos

- All three questions concern things that cannot be done on Shabbos, so he urges them on Erev Shabbos (MB 11).
- He asks close to dark – before bein hashmashos, with time left to add from the weekday onto the holy – so that they will not be negligent and say there is still time (MB 9).
- The gentle tone: these things must be said gently so that they will accept it from him (Shabbos 34a; MB 10); and a person should never impose excessive fear in his household, for out of fear they desecrate Shabbos, feed him something forbidden, and come to several transgressions (the dictum: Gittin 6b; the reasons: MA 2; MB 10).

Melacha: None – these are Erev Shabbos preparations.

The Three Questions

HALACHA 260:2

This is the Mishna (Shabbos 34a): "Three things a person must say in his house on Erev Shabbos at dark: Have you tithed? Have you made an *eruv*? Light the candle."

"Close to dark" **9)** means before *bein hashmashos*, while it is certainly still day and there is still time to add from the weekday onto the holy. He delays until then so that they will not be negligent and say, "There is still time" (MB 9).

The gentle tone **10)** is itself from the Gemara there (Shabbos 34a): these things must be said gently, "so that they will accept it from him" (MB 10). The Magen Avraham and the Mishna Berura add the further reason, from Gittin 6b, that "a person should never impose excessive fear in his household" – out of fear they will desecrate Shabbos, feed him something forbidden, and come to several transgressions (MA 2; MB 10). The Pri Megadim (EA 2) discusses the relation between the two reasons.

All three questions concern things that cannot be done on Shabbos **11)** (MB 11). The Mishna Berura notes that where an *eruv chatzeiros* **12)** is set up only once a year from Erev Pesach to Erev Pesach, and he is not accustomed to make an *eruv techumin*, this question is unnecessary (MB 12); and that nowadays people are not accustomed to ask about challah **13)**, though on Erev Pesach one certainly must (MB 13, Kenesses Yechezkel). The Magen Avraham (3) holds that one should ask about an *eruv chatzeiros* too: although it may be made at *bein hashmashos*, that is only because for a mitzva they permitted a *shevus*, and one should not come to rely on that. The Pri Megadim (EA 3) works through the Magen Avraham's reasoning and the variant readings of the seif at some length.

"Light the candle" **14)** is an instruction, not a question. The **Taz** (3) explains the vocalization: *hadliku* with a *pasach* is imperative, since he sees that it has not been lit and there is no question to ask (MB 14, Rashi) – unlike "Have you tithed?" and "Have you made an *eruv*?" He adds that one who is in a separate room and leaves for the synagogue, not knowing whether it has been lit, may indeed say *hidliku* with a *chirik*, which is a question; the Pri Megadim (MZ 3) emends this to *hidlaktem*, since *hidliku* with a *chirik* serves only as a question. Here too he should warn them to stop doing melacha; and if he is in the study hall or elsewhere, he must send someone to warn them (MA 3; MB 14).

SHULCHAN ARUCH & MEFORSHIM

כשיהיה סמוך לחשיכה ישאל לאנשי ביתו בלשון רכה: עשרתם? ערבתם? הפרשתם חלה? ויאמר להם: הדליקו את הנר: ובמקום שאין מעשרין, א"צ לומר: עשרתם (טור):

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2 When it is close to dark 9), he should ask the members of his household in a gentle tone 10): "Have you tithed? 11) Have you made an eruv? 12) Have you separated challah? 13)" And he should say to them, "Light the candle" 14). (RAMA: And in a place where they do not tithe, he need not say "Have you tithed?" – Tur)

COMMENTARIES, IN ORDER OF THE TEXT

In a gentle tone **בלשון רכה: עשרתם? ערבתם? הפרשתם חלה? ויאמר להם**

MAGEN AVRAHAM 2 **מגן אברהם (ב)**

בל' רכה. דאסור לאדם שיטיל אימה יתירה בתוך ביתו שמתוך היראה הם מחללין שבת ומאכילין לו דבר האסור ובאין לידי כמה עבירות:

In a gentle tone. For it is forbidden for a person to impose excessive fear in his household; for out of fear they desecrate Shabbos, feed him something forbidden, and come to several transgressions.

PRI MEGADIM (ESHEL AVRAHAM) 2 on Magen Avraham 2 **פרי מגדים – אשל אברהם (ב)**

בל' עמ"א ע"ין פרישה וא"ר וגיטין דף וי"ו ב' אל יטיל אימה יתירה ומייתי הא דיאמר בניחותא דלקבלינהו מיניה משמע דמה"ט הוא דאימה יתירה ידליקו בשבת כו' ובתו"ש פי' בע"א יע"ש. עסי' תמ"ד בט"ז ע"פ שבת יזכיר חלה בע"ש שו"ת כנסת יחזקאל סוף חא"ח:

In a gentle [tone] – on the Magen Avraham. See the Perisha and the Eliya Rabba, and Gittin 6b: "a person should not impose excessive fear" – and it brings that he should say it in a pleasant manner so that they will accept it from him. It is implied that it is for this reason that excessive fear [is forbidden] – they will light on Shabbos etc. And in the Tosefes Shabbos he explained it otherwise; see there. See siman 444 in the Taz: when Erev Pesach falls on Shabbos he should mention challah on Erev Shabbos – responsa Kenesses Yechezkel, end of Orach Chaim.

And he says to them, "Light." **ויאמר להם: הדליקו את הנר**

MAGEN AVRAHAM 3 **מגן אברהם (ג)**

הדליקו. וה"ה שיזהירם שיפסיקו מלעשות מלאכה ועסי' רס"ג ונ"ל דצ"ל ג"כ ערבתם ע"ח כמ"ש הטור דאע"ג דמותר לערב ב"ה היינו משום מצוה התירו שבות וא"כ לכתחל' יש להזהירם שלא יבואו לידי כך:

Light. And likewise he should warn them to stop doing melacha; see siman 263. And it seems to me that he must also say "Have you made an *eruv*?" regarding an *eruv chatzeiros*, as the Tur wrote. For although it is permitted to make an *eruv* at *bein hashmashos*, that is because for a mitzva they permitted a *shevus*; if so, initially one should warn them so that they do not come to that.

PRI MEGADIM (ESHEL AVRAHAM) 3 on Magen Avraham 3 **פרי מגדים – אשל אברהם (ג)**

הדליקו עמ"א כמדומה יש חיסור תיבות והמחבר דכתבו עירבתם ולא היא כי בש"ע י"ל עירובי תחומין וכמ"ש התוספות גיטין וי"ו ב' ד"ה עירבתם לכן אמר דעירובי חצירות נמי לכתחלה ודאי ראוי להניח קודם ב"ה ואי שכח מניח לכתחלה ביה"ש ועירובי תחומין אי שכח אין מניח לכתחילה ביה"ש ודיעבד עסי' תט"ו ס"ב ומ"א אות ג' ועב"ח רס"א

Light – on the Magen Avraham. It seems that words are missing, and [regarding] the Mechaber, that they wrote "Have you made an *eruv*" – it is not so; for in the Shulchan Aruch one can say [it refers to] an *eruv techumin*, as Tosfos wrote in Gittin 6b, ד"ה עירבתם. Therefore he said that an *eruv chatzeiros* too should certainly be set up initially before *bein hashmashos*; and if he forgot, he may set it up initially at *bein hashmashos*; whereas with an *eruv techumin*, if he forgot he may not set it up initially at *bein hashmashos*, and [only] after the fact – see siman 415:2 and Magen Avraham paragraph 3, and see the Bach 261.

ומ"ש המ"א משום מצוה התירו שבות א"י כעת דמשמע ע"ת לאו שבות גמור הוא וע"ת אסמכוה אקרא ויראה דסברתו הוא דודאי ע"ח שבות הוא ומשום מצות כבוד שבת שלא יהיו ידיו אסורות מלהוציא ולהכניס התירו ביה"ש בסי' שמ"ב וע"ת אסמכוה אקרא לא רצו להתיר ועדיין צ"ע. וא"ה ברס"א יבואר עוד ועיין ט"ז רס"א ב' שוב ראיתי בנ"ץ בש"ע שלא השמיט עירבתם וכן הלבוש וטעות נפל בד"א עירבת"ם בהמחבר וא"ה ברס"א בט"ז ומ"א יבואר עוד וע"ש אות ו"ו:

And what the Magen Avraham wrote, that for a mitzva they permitted a *shevus* – I do not know at present, for it implies that an *eruv techumin* is not a complete *shevus*, and *eruv techumin* they supported on a verse. And it seems that his reasoning is that an *eruv chatzeiros* is certainly a *shevus*, and because of the mitzva of honoring Shabbos – that his hands not be bound from carrying out and bringing in – they permitted it at *bein hashmashos*, in siman 342; whereas an *eruv techumin*, which they supported on a verse, they did not want to permit. And it still needs study. With Hashem's help it will be explained further in 261. And see Taz 261 paragraph 2. Then I saw in the נ"ץ on the Shulchan Aruch that he did not omit "Have you made an *eruv*", and so the Levush; and an error crept into ד"א in the Mechaber's "עירבתם". With Hashem's help it will be explained further in 261 in the Taz and Magen Avraham; and see there paragraph 6.

TAZ 3 **ט"ז (ג)**

ויאמר להם הדליקו. פי' בפתח תחת הה"א לשון צווי דאין שייך לו' לשון שאלה אם הדליקו את הנר כמו בעשרתם ערבתם שכאן הוא רואה שלא הודלק ומה שאלה יש בדבר ונראה לי דאם הוא בחדר מיוחד והולך משם לבית הנכסת ואינו יודע אם הודלק בבית דירה שפיר יאמר ל' הדליקו בחיר"ק דהוא ל' שאלה:

And he says to them, "Light." Meaning, with a *pasach* under the *heh*, in the imperative; for the language of a question – whether they have lit the candle – does not apply, as with "Have you tithed? Have you made an *eruv*?", since here he sees that it has not been lit, and what question is there in the matter? And it seems to me that if he is in a separate room and goes from there to the synagogue, and does not know whether it has been lit in the living quarters, he may well say "Hidliku" with a *chirik*, which is the language of a question.

PRI MEGADIM (MISHBETZOS ZAHAV) 3 on Taz 3 **פרי מגדים – משבצות זהב (ג)**

ויאמר עט"ז הדליקו בפתח ה"א בפת"ח משמש גם לשאלה ולצווי ג"כ משא"כ הדליקו בחיר"ק משמש רק לשאלה. ויראה היינו הדלקתם בחיר"ק תחת הה"א עיין פירש"י שבת ל"ד א' במשנה.

> **And he says – on the Taz.** "Hadliku" with a *pasach* under the *heh* serves also for a question and for the imperative as well; not so "hidliku" with a *chirik*, which serves only for a question. And it seems that [the Taz] means "hidlaktem" with a *chirik* under the *heh*; see Rashi's explanation, Shabbos 34a, on the Mishna.

ועשרתם פירש"י דסעודת שבת קובעת למעשר אף עראי דעונג כ"ש הוה עונג ולפ"ז ה"ה י"ט קובעת דג"כ עונג בעיני כמו בשבת כבסי' תקכ"ט ור"מ פ"ו מהי"ט הלכה י"ו וברי"מ פ"ג ה"ג מהלכות מעשר השבת קובעת יראה ה"ה י"ט ואין מעשרין בי"ט ג"כ ביצה ל"ו ב' ר"מ ה"ש פכ"ג הט"ו ועיין דרישה דמש"ה בשבת שואל שא"א לעשר בשבת וה"ה בי"ט.

> And "Have you tithed" – Rashi explained that the Shabbos meal fixes [produce] for tithing, even a casual [meal], since it is *oneg*; all the more so is it *oneg*. According to this, the same applies to Yom Tov, which is also *oneg* in his eyes like Shabbos, as in siman 529 and the Rambam, perek 6 of hilchos Yom Tov, halacha 16. And in the Rambam, perek 3 halacha 3 of hilchos Maaser, "Shabbos fixes" – it seems the same applies to Yom Tov; and one may not tithe on Yom Tov either, [see] Beitza 36b, Rambam hilchos Shabbos perek 23 halacha 15. And see the Derisha, that for this reason on Shabbos he asks, since one cannot tithe on Shabbos – and the same on Yom Tov.

וגם עירובי תחומין צריך שישאול ע"ש עם חשיכה כדאיתא בגמ' ל"ד דרישא לע"ת אתיא כו' ועב"ח כאן וברס"א ס"ג והאידנא דדרין בין עכו"ם ל"ש שיערב וה"ה ע"ח כע"ת כו' ופרישה כתב דע"ת לא הזקיקו חז"ל צ"מ קצת וא"כ ה"ה ע"ט צריך לשאול על זה כמו ע"ש חוץ הדליקו את הנר דלא שייך בי"ט ומיהו למ"ד הדלקת הנר בי"ט הוה חובה ופמ"ש בסי' רס"ג ס"ה א"כ בי"ט נמי יאמר עם חשיכה הדליקו הנר דוודאי מצוה שיהא דלוק לכבוד יו"ט קודם ביה"ש וא"כ מ"ש ע"ש דנקיט דכה"ג פריך בכמה מקומות וצ"ע קצת. עיין ר"מ פ"ה מה"ש ה"ג ולבדו"ק אותם ע"כ היינו כשהולך לביה"כ מחדר אחר. ואי"ה ברס"א יבואר בדפוס ישן דיהרן פארט לית תיבת ערבתם עמ"א ג':

> And also an *eruv techumin* he must ask about on Erev Shabbos at dark, as stated in the Gemara 34, that the first clause follows *eruv techumin* etc.; and see the Bach here and in 261:3. And nowadays, when we dwell among non-Jews, it does not apply that he should make an *eruv*; and the same with an *eruv chatzeiros*, like an *eruv techumin* etc. And the Perisha wrote that the Sages did not require an *eruv techumin* – [this] needs a little study. If so, the same applies to Erev Yom Tov: he must ask about this as on Erev Shabbos, except for "Light the candle", which does not apply on Yom Tov. However, according to the one who says that lighting the candle on Yom Tov is an obligation, and according to what is written in siman 263:5 – if so, on Yom Tov too he should say at dark "Light the candle", for it is certainly a mitzva that it be lit for the honor of Yom Tov before *bein hashmashos*. And if so, why did he mention Erev Shabbos? For in such a way [the Gemara] objects in several places; and this needs a little study. See the Rambam, perek 5 of hilchos Shabbos halacha 3, "and to check them" – perforce this is when he goes to the synagogue from another room. With Hashem's help it will be explained in 261. In the old Dyhernfurth printing the word "ערבתם" is absent; see Magen Avraham 3.

MISHNA BERURA ON THIS SEIF

MISHNA BERURA 9 **משנה ברורה (ט)**

סמוך לחשיכה – היינו קודם בין השמשות בעוד ודאי יום ושיהיה בו עוד שהות להוסיף מחול על הקודש והטעם שמאחר מלישאל עד עתה כדי שלא יפשעו ויאמרו עדיין יש שהות:

> **Close to dark** – That is, before *bein hashmashos*, while it is certainly still day, and while there is still time to add from the weekday onto the holy. And the reason he delays asking until now is so that they will not be negligent and say, "There is still time."

MISHNA BERURA 10 **משנה ברורה (י)**

בלשון רכה – כי היכי דליקבלו מניה ולעולם אל יטיל אדם אימה יתירה בתוך ביתו שמתוך היראה הם מחללין שבת ומאכילין לאדם דבר האסור לו ובאין לידי כמה עבירות:

> **In a gentle tone** – So that they will accept it from him. And a person should never impose excessive fear in his household; for out of fear they desecrate Shabbos, feed a person something forbidden to him, and come to several transgressions.

MISHNA BERURA 11 **משנה ברורה (יא)**

עשרתם וכו' – דכל הני אין יכול לעשותם אח"כ בשבת לכך יזרז אודותם בע"ש:

> **Have you tithed etc.** – For all of these he cannot do afterwards on Shabbos; therefore he urges them about them on Erev Shabbos.

MISHNA BERURA 12 **משנה ברורה (יב)**

ערבתם – ובמקומות שאין דרך להניח עירובי חצרות כ"א מע"פ לע"פ וגם עירובי תחומין אין דרכו להניח אין צריך לומר זה:

Have you made an eruv – And in places where it is not the way to set up an *eruv chatzeiros* except from one Erev Pesach to the next, and where he is not accustomed to set up an *eruv techumin* either, he need not say this.

MISHNA BERURA 13 **משנה ברורה (יג)**

הפרשתם חלה – וכעת אין נוהגין לישאל זה ועיין בתשובות כנסת יחזקאל סי' ק"ג שכתב טעם לזה אך בע"פ בודאי צריך לישאל ואם חל בשבת צריך לישאל בע"ש ע"ש:

Have you separated challah – And nowadays people are not accustomed to ask this; and see the responsa Kenesses Yechezkel siman 103, who wrote a reason for this. But on Erev Pesach one certainly must ask; and if [Pesach] falls on Shabbos, he must ask on Erev Shabbos; see there.

MISHNA BERURA 14 **משנה ברורה (יד)**

הדליקו וכו' – בפת"ח תחת הה"א בלשון צווי דאין שייך שאלה דהא רואה שלא הודלק [רש"י] וה"ה שיזהירם שיפסקו מלעשות מלאכה ואם הוא אז בבה"מ או במקום אחר צריך לשלוח אחר שיזהירם לזה:

Light etc. – With a *pasach* under the *heh*, in the imperative; for a question does not apply, since he sees that it has not been lit [Rashi]. And likewise he should warn them to stop doing melacha. And if he is then in the study hall or in another place, he must send someone to warn them about this.